

402MAN

Communication and Collaboration

Assignment and introduction to communication



Coventry University

**Top 15 UK university
5 years running**

Guardian University Guide 2016-2020

Coventry University

**Gold for outstanding
teaching and learning**

Teaching Excellence
Framework (TEF) 2017

Coventry University

**97% employed
or in further study**

DLHE survey, UG UK, 2016/17
(published 2018)

What are we going to cover today?

- Introduction to this module [402MAN – Communication and Collaboration]
- Overview of assignments 1 & 2
- What is Communication and Collaboration?

Key Links

Timetable

- [Check your timetable | Wayfinder \(coventry.ac.uk\)](#)

Lib Guides

- <https://libguides.coventry.ac.uk/cuglibraries/Home>

Referencing

- https://libguides.coventry.ac.uk/ld.php?content_id=33132170

Extensions/Deferrals

- <https://wayfinder.coventry.ac.uk/help-centre/apply-for-an-extension-or-deferral.html#apply-for-an-extension>

Learning Outcomes

1. **Demonstrate** a knowledge of the **core principles, theories** and differing methods of communication and collaboration within a range of organisational contexts.
2. **Reflect** upon your **own interpersonal, communication and collaborative skills** and identify areas for improvement.
3. **Demonstrate** an **understanding of working with others, teamwork, groups** and group dynamics and across organisational boundaries.
4. **Demonstrate** a knowledge of **how to communicate and collaborate** effectively using appropriate techniques
5. **Explain** how **management, organisational culture and structure** can impact communication and collaboration within and between organisations.
6. **Explain** **effective communication and collaboration** within an organisation.

Assignments

Hand in

Assignment 1 – 1,500-word reflective blog

28/03/2025 6pm

Assignment 2 – 10-minute group presentation
500-word reflection

17/04/2025 6pm

Assignment 1

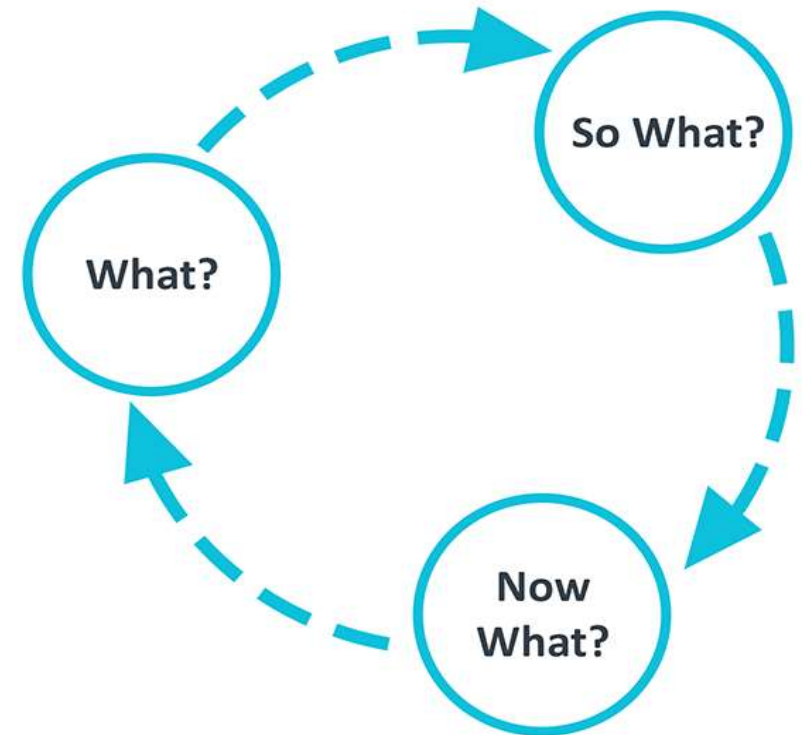
1,500 word self-reflection blog using Driscoll reflective model

Use the Post Office as a case study, you should reflect on the communication and collaboration which took place in the highly scrutinised Post Office scandal.

- You should include key academic theories and principles within your reflective blog (LO1).
- You should also reflect on your own interpersonal, communication and collaborative skills to identify areas you would have acted different, and areas which you could improve because of this reflective blog (LO2).

Driscoll Reflective Model

- Driscoll (1994) developed this model of reflection based on the three simple questions – What? So what? Now what?
- **'What?'** helps you describe the situation you want to learn from. You should identify the facts and feelings of the situation.
- **'So What?'** allows you to extract the meaning of 'What?'. Moreover, you should question what knowledge you and others had in the situation, and **what knowledge or theories that could help you make sense of the situation (LO1).**
- **'Now what?'** allows you to create an action plan for the future based on the previous questions. (LO2)



(The University of Edinburgh, 2024)

Apply Driscoll Reflective Model to your assignment (Example)

WHAT? Description of a particular event in relation to the Post Office.

The Post Office Horizon scandal involved the wrongful prosecution of over 700 sub-postmasters between 1999 and 2015 due to apparent financial discrepancies shown by the Horizon IT system. Sub-postmasters were accused of theft, fraud, and false accounting when the system showed shortfalls in their accounts, despite them insisting the errors were system-based.

So WHAT? Analyse the particular event you identified and then use Communication and Collaboration theory to analyse.

In this example we have used: Shannon and Weaver's Communication Theory

The Horizon system evidenced transmitter and channel issues, this was evident in the technical problems within the Horizon system which created noise in the communication channel..... (You will be expected to analyse this application of theory further and apply to the Post Office case study).

Now WHAT? Following your analysis, what have you learned to help support your future application as a manager.

Upon reflection, of the Horizon systems faults. It has provided an opportunity to learn and consider the implementation of system management skills when implementing a I.T reliant system into organisations. In particular, it has encouraged learning to manage and recognise early warning signs of systemic problems and to maintain documentation of issues and responses.

Salut!

Hi!

Hallo!

Hello!

नमस्ते

Bonjour!

Olá!

ciao!

您好

مرحبا



COMMUNICATION

What is happening in the world?

[Home](#) | [Cost of Living](#) | [War In Ukraine](#) | [Coronavirus](#) | [Climate](#) | [UK](#) | [World](#) | [Business](#) | [Politics](#) | [Tech](#) | [Science](#) | [Health](#) | [Family & Education](#) | [More](#) ▾

[Business](#) | [Your Money](#) | [Market Data](#) | [Companies](#) | [Economy](#) | [Technology of Business](#) | [CEO Secrets](#) | [Global Trade](#)



Warning Christmas debt could take years to repay

Advisers warn of pain to come as a poll for the BBC suggests many have no idea how they will repay festive spending.

🕒 2h | Business

- What do I do if I can't afford to pay my debts?
- Dr Ranj: How to protect your mental health as debt rises
- Who will get £900 to help with energy bills?



What do I do if I can't afford to pay my debts?

What help and options are available to people struggling with debt repayments?

🕒 1h | Business



Britishvolt hopes for last-minute rescue bid

The new bidder is described as "a British consortium", according to people familiar with the matter.

🕒 9m | Business



M&S to create 3,400 jobs as it opens new stores

The retailer says it will open 20 stores in the next year, including five in former Debenhams sites.

🕒 1h | Business | 🗨️



Dr Ranj: How to protect your mental health as debt rises

The rising cost of living can be stressful but there are steps you can take to help.

🕒 1h | Business



Lab-grown alternatives aim to cut palm oil dependence



Energy boss warns higher bills are here to stay

Equinor's chief says while prices will not be as volatile, investment in renewables must be paid for.

🕒 2h | Business | 🗨️

What is communication?

Sharing Information

Communication is the process of conveying information. It includes ideas, thoughts, feelings, and emotions. This exchange can happen in various forms.

Creating Understanding

Effective communication aims to create shared understanding. It ensures the message is received and comprehended as intended.

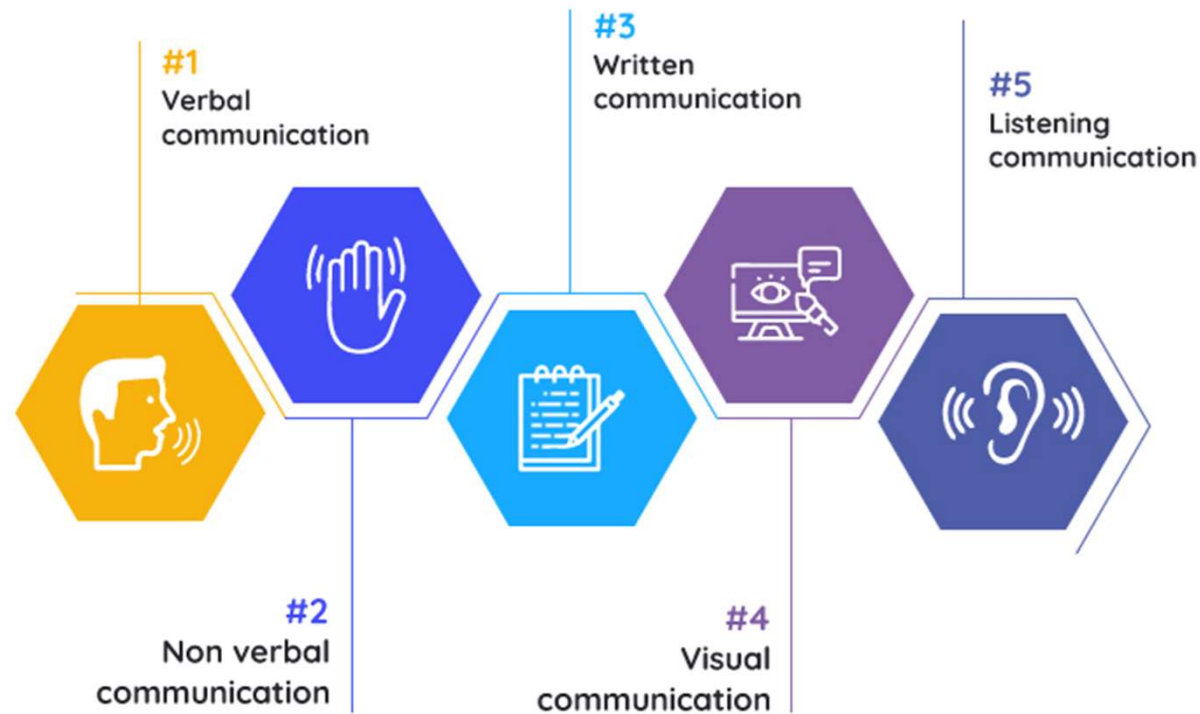
Building Relationships

Communication is fundamental to building and maintaining relationships. It fosters connection, trust, and mutual respect.



Forms of communication

5 Forms of Communication at Workplace



Understand These 5 Types of Communication at Workplace, 2019

Verbal communication

The Oxford English Dictionary defines Verbal communication as:

... relating to words.

Task:

What role does verbal communication play in a workplace?

Non-Verbal communication

The Collins English Dictionary defines non-verbal communication as:

... those aspects of communication such as gestures and facial expressions that do not involve verbal communication but may include non-verbal aspects of speech.

Task:

What role does non-verbal communication play in a workplace?

Non- verbal communication

Non- verbal communication is further made up of:

Made up of the following parts:

1. Visual
2. Tactile
3. Use of time, space, and image

Non- verbal communication

Visual:

This often called body language and includes facial expression, eye movement, posture, and gestures

For example, in American culture agreement might be indicated by the head going up and down whereas in India, a side-to-side head movement might mean the same thing.

Posture:

For example...

posture can indicate self-confidence, aggressiveness, fear, guilt, or anxiety.

Non- verbal communication

Tactile:

This involves the use of touch to impart meaning as in a handshake, a pat on the back, an arm around the shoulder, a kiss, or a hug.

Non- verbal communication

Use of time, space, and image:

Time:

Use of time can communicate how we view our own status and power in relation to others.

What does it communicate if you're late for a meeting? What might you want to convey?

Physical Space:

Dependent on which culture you're from, the distance you create between yourself and other can send all sorts of messages.

Northern Europe, Arabian countries and Latin America. Lots of touching perhaps....or not

Non-verbal communication

Non-verbal cues can play five roles:

1. Repetition: they can repeat the message the person is making verbally
2. Contradiction: they can contradict a message the individual is trying to convey
3. Substitution: they can substitute for a verbal message. For example, a person's eyes can often convey a far more vivid message than words and often do
4. Complementing: they may add to or complement a verbal message. A boss who pats a person on the back in addition to giving praise can increase the impact of the message
5. Accenting: non-verbal communication may accept or underline a verbal message. Pounding the table, for example, can underline a message.

Non- verbal communication

Skillful communicators understand the importance of non-verbal communication and use it to increase their effectiveness, as well as use it to understand more clearly what someone else is really saying.

Be aware of cultural differences when working with a culture other than your own.

For example , how you may treat someone older than yourself in China....

Task:

Reflect on your own non-verbal communication skills... How can you become more effective in your own non-verbal communication?

Summary

Difference between verbal and non-verbal communication

	VERBAL COMMUNICATION 	NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION 
DEFINITION	Everything we express in words	Everything we are able to transmit through gestures and body language.
LANGUAGE	Uses words and linguistic signs	Based on body language and paralinguistic features
CHANNELS	Spoken or written	Expression, gestures and body language, covering from facial expressions and movements of the extremities to posture
ADDRESSEE	Can be present or not	Must be paying visual attention
ADVANTAGES	• Fast and the message always tends to be clear • Offers the chance for correction • Conscious and reasoned • Improves attention	• Conveys emotions and feelings • Complements verbal communication as it helps to better connect with addressees and display other characteristics and qualities of the speaker

(Verbal and Non-Verbal Communication in Female Leadership, n.d.)

Barriers to Effective Communication

- Language
- Defensiveness, distorted perceptions, guilt, projection, transference, distortions from the past
- Mis-reading of language, tone, and other non-verbal forms of communication
- 'noisy transmission' (unreliable messages, inconsistency)
- power struggles
- self-fulfilling assumptions
- managers hesitation to be candid
- assumptions—e.g., assuming others see situation same as you, has same feelings as you

Barriers to Effective Communication

Perceptual Biases:

People attend to stimuli in the environment in very different ways. We each have shortcuts that we use to organise data. Invariably, these shortcuts introduce some biases into communication

Stereotyping is one of the most common. This is when we assume that the other person has certain characteristics based on the group to which they belong without validating that they in fact have these characteristics

Barriers to Effective Communication

Interpersonal Relationships:

How we perceive communication is affected by the past experience with the individual.

Perception is also affected by the organizational relationship two people have.

For example, communication from a superior may be perceived differently than that from a subordinate or peer

Barriers to Effective Communication

Cultural Differences:

Given some dramatic differences across cultures in approaches to such areas as time, space, and privacy, the opportunities for miscommunication while we are in cross-cultural situations are plentiful.

Post-Lesson Task

Five Ways to Improve Your Verbal Communication Skills



Reflect on today's lesson and consider your own communication style. How do you communicate and are there ways you could improve your verbal and non-verbal communication to become more skilful in the art of communication?

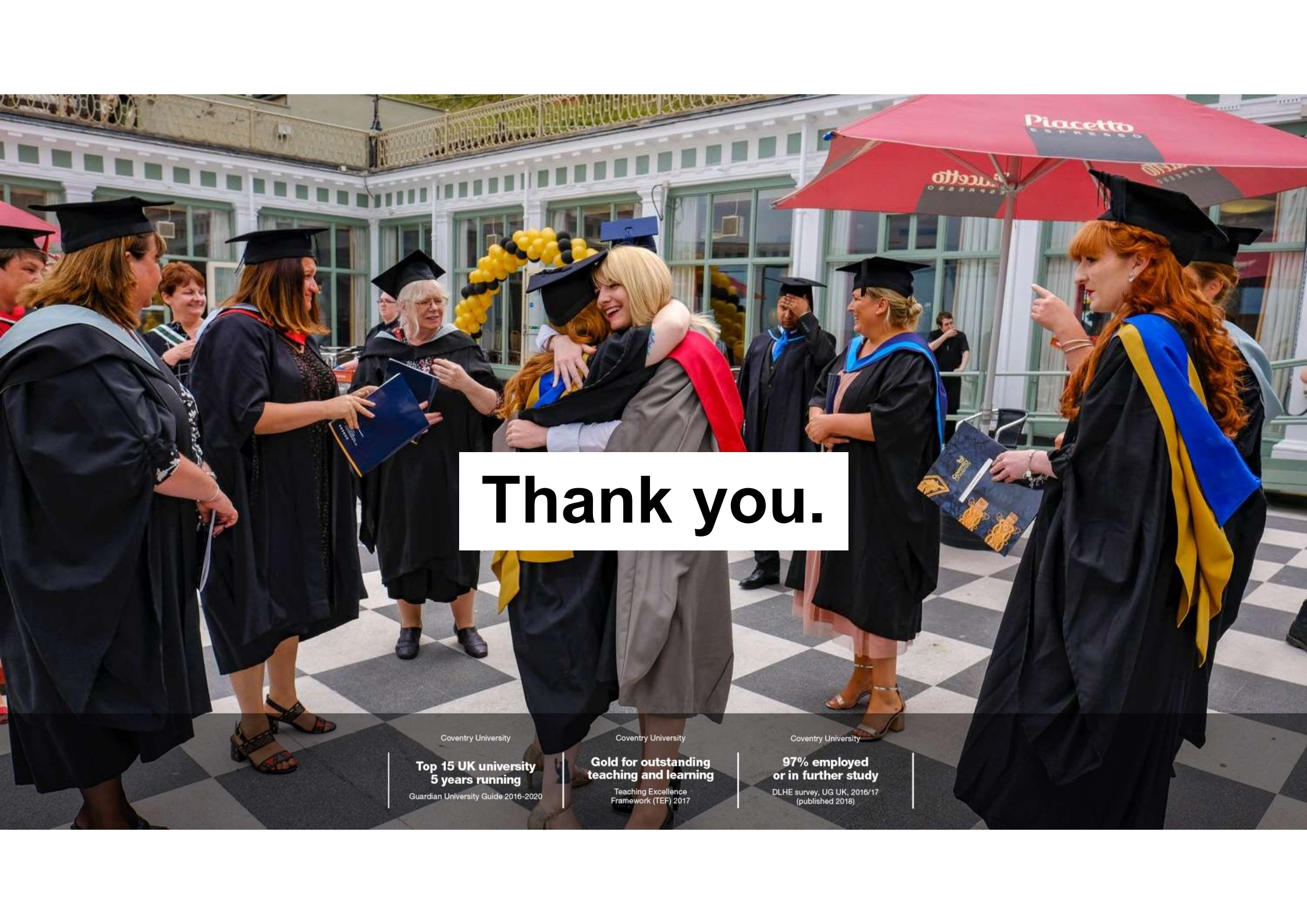
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The University of Edinburgh. (2024). What? So what? Now what? The University of Edinburgh. <https://reflection.ed.ac.uk/reflection-toolkit/reflecting-on-experience/what-so-what-now-what>

The Importance of Effective Communication Edward G. Wertheim, Ph.D. Northeastern University, College of Business Administration

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Thank you.

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